



PLATFORM OVERVIEW · JULY 2026

Care that feels like *kindred*.

A complete picture of the platform as it stands today: what it is, how every person uses it, how it earns, what's already live, and what comes next. Written for reading, not for engineers.



85%

of every booking goes to the carer

6%

is all a family pays on top of the carer's own rate

Status: built and live at mariska-gray.vercel.app in pre-launch test mode. No real users or payments yet, by design.

THE IDEA

A marketplace for care, where everyone keeps more

Kindred introduces families to **vetted, self-employed carers and nurses** across the UK, and keeps the whole relationship in one place: finding someone, meeting them, booking visits, paying, and staying safe. Families deal directly with the person who cares for them, not a call-centre. Carers run their own working lives instead of handing half their pay to an agency.

Legally, Kindred is an **introduction agency**: it does not employ carers or deliver care itself, which places it outside the Care Quality Commission's remit. Every carer is vetted to CQC-equivalent standards, and the site says all of this plainly rather than hiding it.

For families

Browse full profiles free. Meet for free. Book by the hour at a transparent all-in price. Stay with a carer your loved one genuinely likes.

For carers & nurses

Free to join. Set your own rate and keep 85% of it. Choose your clients. Paid after every visit, with the paperwork handled.

For the agency

One dashboard to vet applicants, keep every document in date automatically, coordinate introductions, and watch the money.

WHY THIS SHAPE

Built on evidence, not guesswork

Before building, fourteen UK competitors were researched in depth: who survived, who died, and why. The pattern was stark. Every surviving marketplace keeps payments on the platform and takes a commission. The two that died (SuperCarers and Care Sourcer) both made their introductions and then let the money walk away. Kindred's model, pricing, vetting bar and even its launch strategy come from that research, which lives in the project files and remains the reference for future decisions.



How it makes money

Kindred earns a small slice of every hour of care booked through the platform, from both sides:

From the carer

15%

of their self-set rate. They keep 85%.
Traditional agencies keep 50 to 60% of what families pay; this is the recruiting pitch that fills the platform with good carers.

From the family

6%

added to the carer's rate. The all-in price is shown on every profile and every booking before anything is committed. No joining fees, no subscriptions.

A worked example: a carer charging £20 an hour

The family pays	£21.20 per hour (£20 + 6%)
The carer receives	£17.00 per hour (£20 – 15%)
Kindred earns	£4.20 per hour (about 21% of the money flowing through)

A typical 30-hour week with one client: roughly £126/week for the platform, recurring for as long as the care relationship lasts. Live-in care (around £1,200/week) is proportionally larger.

Why commission and not one-off fees

The original plan charged families to unlock profiles (£25), book interviews (£15) and a one-off introduction fee (£350 to £650), with care paid privately afterwards. The market research showed that exact model is the one both dead competitors ran: revenue stops at the introduction, while the care (and the money) continues for months or years. Commission on an ongoing relationship is worth several times a one-off fee, and it aligns the platform with keeping matches working, not just making them. The decision is recorded formally (DR-0001) with the warning signs to watch.

Also in the model

- ✓ Referral rewards: carers earn £25 to £75 for introducing professionals who pass vetting
- ✓ A manual introduction-fee tool remains for unusual off-platform placements

Deliberately free

- ✓ Browsing full profiles
- ✓ Meet & greets (the step that creates bookings)
- ✓ Joining as a carer or nurse

JOURNEY ONE

A family finds care

01 Create a free account

Name and email, nothing else. No card, no charge, no obligation.

02 Browse full profiles, free

Filter by type of care (live-in, dementia, end-of-life, respite, companionship, nursing specialisms), location and availability. Every profile shows the person properly: experience, rates, interests, languages, verification badges, and their vetting status.

03 Meet for free

Request a meet & greet from any profile. The team coordinates a time, by video or in person. No contact details change hands; everything runs through the platform.

04 Book, pay, and settle in

Propose the hours you want. The full price is shown up front. The carer accepts, you pay securely through the platform, the visit happens, you confirm it went ahead, and the carer is paid. Repeat with the same carer for as long as it works.



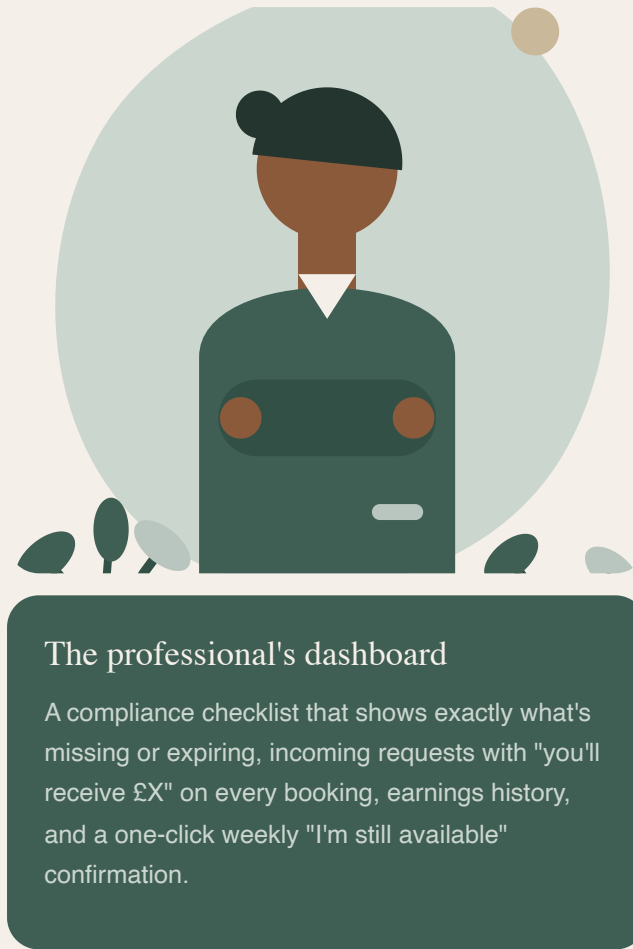
The family's dashboard

- ✓ Upcoming visits and pending requests
- ✓ Meet & greets, with video links when scheduled
- ✓ Every booking's full price breakdown
- ✓ Total spent, all in one place

What they never see

Hidden fees, invented review scores, or a carer whose paperwork has lapsed. Profiles with out-of-date checks disappear from search automatically.

A carer or nurse joins



01 Apply in minutes

Name, carer or nurse, town, years of experience. Free to join, always.

02 Prove who you are

Upload documents to a private vault: enhanced DBS, right to work, photo ID, two references and training certificates. Nurses also provide their NMC registration and indemnity insurance. The team checks every document and interviews every applicant before a profile goes live.

03 Build your profile, set your rate

Bio, specialisms, availability pattern, languages, interests, photo and intro video. You decide what your time is worth; you keep 85% of it.

04 Work on your terms

Accept the meet & greets and bookings you want, decline the ones you don't. Paid after every completed visit into your own payout account. Refer other good carers and earn £25 to £75 when they pass vetting.

Tiers worth earning

Bronze to Platinum badges recognise experience and specialisms (dementia, end-of-life, complex care), awarded by the team and shown on profiles.

JOURNEY THREE

Running the agency

Staff sign in to the same website as everyone else and see the operations dashboard. Staff accounts can't be self-registered; they're created deliberately, one by one.

Vetting & applications

Every applicant with their status, a document review queue (view, approve, or reject with a note the applicant sees), interview sign-off, and tier awards.

Compliance traffic lights

Everyone is scored green, amber or red automatically from their documents. The overview lists everything expiring in the next 60 days, and who's gone quiet.

Introductions & bookings

Schedule meet & greets and attach video links. See every booking with its full money split: what the family paid, what the carer gets, what Kindred earned.

Safeguarding

A flag queue for complaints, missed interviews and concerns, with a resolve-or-dismiss workflow and full history per professional.

THE QUIET MACHINERY

Compliance that runs itself

The most labour-intensive part of a care agency (keeping every DBS, insurance certificate and training record in date) is automated. Every document carries an expiry date. Reminders go out at 60, 30 and 7 days before expiry, and again on the day. A carer whose paperwork lapses turns red and **vanishes from family searches automatically**, then reappears the moment the team approves a renewal. Weekly nudges keep availability honest; a profile nobody has confirmed for a month stops being shown. A daily automatic check keeps all of this ticking without anyone remembering to do it.

Where the money sits today

Payments currently run in a simulated test mode: every flow works end to end, but no real money moves and every transaction is marked as a test. Switching real payments on is configuration, not construction: open the payment account, drop in the keys, and families pay by card while carers receive payouts into their own accounts. A safety catch prevents test mode from ever activating accidentally once the platform is live.

Live today, and what's next

Already built and live

- ✓ Public site with illustrated design
- ✓ Honest, source-backed claims only
- ✓ Family search, profiles & booking
- ✓ Free meet & greet flow
- ✓ Carer application & document vault
- ✓ Earnings & payout tracking
- ✓ Full agency dashboard
- ✓ Automatic compliance engine
- ✓ Email notifications (ready to switch on)
- ✓ Simulated payments, end to end

The path to launch

STEP	WHAT IT UNLOCKS	EFFORT
1. Choose a domain	Real email sending, passwordless sign-in codes (already built and waiting), a professional address	A decision + ~£10/yr
2. Confirm the name	The identity everywhere: site, emails, legal docs. One-line change technically; needs a trademark sense-check first ("CareMatch" has known prior use)	A decision
3. Open the Stripe account	Real card payments from families and real payouts to carers	An afternoon
4. Real contact details	Replace the placeholder phone number and email on the site	Minutes
5. Recruit the founding cohort	First vetted carers in one region (the research is emphatic: density in one place beats thin national coverage), then first families, then real testimonials	The real work

Soon after launch

- ✓ Staff invitations from the dashboard
- ✓ Reviews and ratings from real matches
- ✓ Backup-carer cover for holidays and sickness

Bigger bets, when ready

- ✓ Council & Direct Payments partnerships
- ✓ Care notes families can follow
- ✓ Town-by-town pages as supply grows

The living version of this document is the PRD (Docs/prd.md in the project), updated as the platform changes. Decisions with lasting consequences are recorded in Docs/decisions/, and the competitor research that shaped the model is in Docs/research/. July 2026.